



Finding out whether a port is open or not

Often, administrators need to find out whether a port is open or not on a particular system. You can use the 'nc' command for this:

Here are some examples.

```
$ nc -zv 192.168.0.90 8080
```

The above command gives the following output if the 8080 port is opened on 192.168.0.90.

```
"Connection to 192.168.0.90 8080 port [tcp/http-alt]
succeeded!"
```

And if the same command gives the following output, then it indicates that the port is closed.

```
"nc: connect to 192.168.13.13 port 8080 (tcp) failed:
Connection refused"
```

The following command can be used to find out what ports are open between 8080 and 8083 on the machine with the IP address 192.168.0.90.

```
$ nc -zv 192.168.0.90 8080-8083
```

—Nagaraju Dhulipalla, nagarajunice@gmail.com

A bunch of tips

Reusing a part of the previous command in the current instruction: You can add !\$ with your command to use the previous extension.

For example:

```
$ ls /krishna
```

Next, run the following command:

```
$ cd !$
```

In this command, !\$ will replace /krishna. This comes very handy when the operand part of the

command is very long.

Reusing the last command in the current one:

To reuse the last command, use '!!' on the terminal. The previous command will get executed as soon as you press *Enter*.

For example:

```
$sudo apt-get install python3
error : lock is not available.
$ sudo !!
```

Doing this will automatically replace '!!' with the last command, which will then get executed.

Emptying a file: We can empty the contents of a file without deleting it by using the following command:

```
$ > file_name
```

This can be very useful to empty a large log file.

—Sai Krishna, settykrishh.93@gmail.com

Navigate faster through long commands on the Ubuntu terminal

It's always difficult to move towards the beginning or end of a command, after typing a command which is long, or even when you want to move a word forward or backward. Here are a few shortcuts that can be used to navigate through long commands.

Ctrl + a moves the cursor to the beginning of a command

Ctrl + e moves the cursor to the end of a command

Alt + b skips one word backward

Alt + f skips one word forward

Ctrl + l clears the terminal screen (similar to the *clear* command)

Ctrl + u deletes text from the cursor to the start of the command line

Ctrl + k deletes text from the cursor to the end of the command line

Consider the following command:

```
$ps -ef | grep python
```